

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.23 .18th July 022



THE POWER OF TOUCH

• **FOCUS: THE POWER OF THE TOUCH OF THE HANDS IN OUR SERVICE/ MINISTRY FOR CHRIST.**

SUBJECT:

- ◆ **JESUS TOUCHED PEOPLE WITH HIS HANDS** AND LEFT US AN EXAMPLE THAT, THERE IS SOMETHING **SPECIAL** AND **UNIQUE** IN THE **TOUCH** OF THE **HUMAN HAND**.
- ◆ WE ARE COMMANDED BY SCRIPTURE **TO PLACE OUR HANDS ON SICK PEOPLE**, WHEN PRAYING FOR THEIR RECOVERY.
 - *They will place their hands on sick people, and they will get well."* Mark 16:18 NIV

THE POWER OF TOUCH.

JESUS TOLD THE STORY of the father and his prodigal son returning home.

Luke 15:18-20

18 I will get up and go to my father and say to him, "Father, I have sinned against heaven and against you. **19** I am no longer worthy to be called your son; treat me like one of your hired workers." **20** So he got up and went to his father. But while he was still a long way from home his father saw him, and his heart went out to him; he ran and hugged his son and kissed him. NET

- ◆ HE **HUGGED** HIS SON AND **KISSED** HIM.
- ◆ HE **TOUCHED** his lost son (with his hug & kiss).



THE FATHER'S ACTIONS

He ran to his son threw his arms around him, and kissed him.

THESE SIMPLE ACTIONS of the father displayed to his son the intentions and attitude OF HIS FATHER'S HEART- IT SAID IT ALL.

NO WORDS WERE SPOKEN - ONLY TOUCH

Jesus in telling the story didn't mention of the father saying anything directly to his Son.

There was nothing like; "I'm so glad you're home! welcome" or "I have missed you so much."

THERE WAS NO NEED FOR THE FATHER TO SPEAK WORDS OF WELCOME, FORGIVENESS OR ACCEPTANCE – **ALL this WAS BEAUTIFULL TRANSMITTED / CONVEYED** IN THE ACT OF TOUCHING – (the hugging, embracing & kissing).- AND

THE SON **CLEARLY UNDERSTOOD** WHAT HIS **FATHER'S TOUCH MEANT.**

WHAT AN **AMAZING EXAMPLE** OF THE FATHER'S ACTIONS in his first encounter with his returning Son?

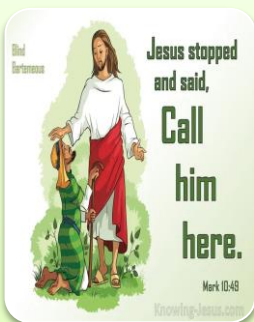
What LESSON might WE learn from the fathers actions?

What might WE be able to IMITATE in today's society and the world we live in?

Quotes on touch

Of all the gifts we can give to people, the gift of our touch is one of the most priceless. Through our hands we convey a kind of radiance. A warmth seeps out from our inner fire, a wrap for someone's chill, a light for another's dark. (Jan Phillips)

The human touch is that little snippet of physical affection that brings a bit of comfort, support and kindness. It doesn't take much from the one who gives it, but can make a huge difference in the one who receives it." nothing eases suffering like human touch."



• JESUS ACTUALLY TOUCHED PEOPLE WITH HIS HANDS

- Jesus touched the leper
- **Matthew 8:3** And Jesus put forth his hand, and touched him, saying, I will; be thou clean. And immediately his leprosy was cleansed. KJV (Mark 1:41 Luke 5:12-13)
- Jesus touched Peter's mother in law
- **Matthew 8:15** And he touched her hand, and the fever left her: and she arose, and ministered unto them. KJV
- Jesus touched the two blind men's eyes
- **Matthew 20:34** Jesus had compassion on them and touched their eyes. Immediately they received their sight and followed him. NIV (Matthew 9:29)
- Jesus touched the ears and tongue of a man.
- **Mark 7:32-33** They brought to him a deaf man who had difficulty speaking, and they asked him to place his hands on him. 33 After Jesus took him aside privately, away from the crowd, he put his fingers in the man's ears, and after spitting, he touched his tongue. NET
- Jesus touched the (bier) coffin or the widow's dead son
- **Luke 7:14-15**
- **14** Then he walked over to the coffin and touched it, and the bearers stopped. "Young man," he said, "I tell you, get up." **15** Then the dead boy sat up and began to talk! And Jesus gave him back to his mother. NLT

PEOPLE DESIRED FOR THE HANDS OF JESUS TO TOUCH THEM?

★ "And besought him TO TOUCH HIM. Mark 8:22

- Jesus took the blind man by the hand and touched his eyes with spit

Mark 8:22-25

22 And he cometh to Bethsaida; and they bring a blind man unto him, and besought him to touch him. **23** And he took the blind man by the hand, and led him out of the town; and when he had spit on his eyes, and put his hands upon him, he asked him if he saw ought. **24** And he looked up, and said, I see men as trees, walking. **25** After that he put his hands again upon his eyes, and made him look up: and he was restored, and saw every man clearly. KJV

- Those who brought the Children to Jesus wanted the children to be touched by Jesus Hands.
- Luke 18:15** And they brought unto him also infants, that he would touch them: but when his disciples saw it, they rebuked them. KJV, Mark 10:13
- Mark 8:22** And he cometh to Bethsaida; and they bring a blind man unto him, and besought him to touch him. KJV

" TOUCH IS FAR MORE ESSENTIAL THAN OUR OTHER SENSES. IT'S TEN TIMES STRONGER THAN VERBAL OR EMOTIONAL CONTACT."

(Saul Schanberg)

■ WHY DID JESUS PHYSICALLY TOUCH PEOPLES PHYSICAL BODIES?

- To convey empathy, sympathy, compassion, understanding and identify with.
- To show his desire to have a more personal attachment / involvement in people's lives and their circumstances.
- He is really saying; "I care about you" – "I understand what you are going through" – "and I desire to help"

■ MAY WE ALSO IN OUR MINISTRY AND SERVICE FOR CHRIST FIND APPROPRIATE WAYS OF OUR HAND'S TOUCHING PEOPLE'S LIVES.

CAUTION NEEDED

- ▶ **Firstly**; to note that in this reflection the power of touch with the hands is in the specific context of our ministry / service for Christ; and of our following Jesus' example of touching people's lives with his hands so as to specifically convey his responsiveness and compassion that he felt for them.
- **Secondly**; because in some cultures it is offensive to physically touch another person – and this includes someone of the opposite sex. So we will need to find alternate ways to express your empathy, sympathy, compassion, and desire to identify with people's needs.
- **Thirdly**; in today's society we must be extremely careful of inappropriately touching of people, therefore we must make sure that if touching people (such as in prayer for healing or other needs) it must be in an appropriate setting with others present. - 2 Corinthians 6:3 we do not give anyone an occasion for taking an offense in anything, so that no fault may be found with our ministry. NET

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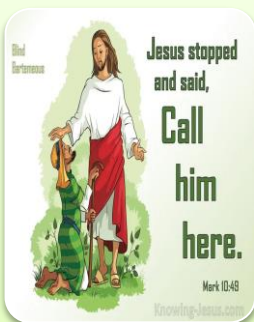
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